

USING WASHES

Below you can see some of the many different ways in which washes can be used. While a flat wash is good for painting large areas and backgrounds, more complex washes can express

mood or be used for natural elements. Graded washes, for example, give skies a sense of depth. Variegated washes, on the other hand, are excellent for colorful sunsets.



Combining washes

A flat wash of cerulean blue has been painted on the top third of the paper and allowed to dry evenly. The lower part of the painting is created with a broken wash.

Flat wash



The flat background wash makes the colors of the flower really stand out in contrast.

Graded wash



The neutral, graded background wash is pale at the bottom, making the leaves and jar stand out.

Variegated wash



The variegated background wash is colorful and suggests an area of interest behind the flower.